

INCIDENT REPORT

Executive Summary

On 06 May 2026, a Cowrie SSH honeypot was successfully deployed on a VMware virtual machine for security testing and research purposes.

A reconnaissance scan was performed from a Kali Linux attacker machine, confirming that the honeypot is operational and listening on port **2222**. The service is correctly emulating an OpenSSH server, as intended.

The honeypot is functioning as expected and ready for further attacker simulation and interaction testing.

System Details

Parameter	Value
Host IP Address	192.168.1.32
MAC Address	00:0C:29:15:80:C2
Virtualization Platform	VMware Virtual Platform
Honeypot Software	Cowrie v2.9.19.dev3+g23fcef400
Listening Port	TCP/2222
Emulated Service	OpenSSH 9.2p1 Debian 2+deb12u3
Operating System	Linux (Debian emulation)

Scan Summary

Tool Used: Nmap 7.99 **Scan Command:** nmap -sV -p 2222 -Pn -oA cowrie_scan 192.168.1.32 **Scan Date & Time:** 06 May 2026 11:16:58

Scan Result:

- a) **Port 2222/tcp:** Open
- b) **Service:** SSH
- c) **Version:** OpenSSH 9.2p1 Debian 2+deb12u3 (protocol 2.0)
- d) **Host Status:** Up (0.00040s latency)

Evidence Collected			
File Name	Size	Description	Location
cowrie_scan.txt	570 bytes	Nmap scan report (human readable)	/home/kali/Downloads/
cowrie.scan.pcapng	108.56 MB	Full packet capture of the scan	/home/kali/Downloads/
cowrie_scan.nmap / .xml	—	Additional Nmap output formats	Scan directory

Conclusions

- a) The Cowrie honeypot is **successfully running** and reachable from the testing network.
- b) Service fingerprinting is working as expected (masquerading as a legitimate Debian OpenSSH server).
- c) No connectivity or configuration blocking issues were observed during the scan.

Recommendations

- a) Update etc/cowrie.cfg with realistic hostname and system information.
- b) Consider enabling Telnet service (port 23) for broader attack surface.
- c) Configure additional output modules (e.g., MySQL, Splunk, or ELK).

Report Status: Completed **Honeypot Operational Status:** Active